

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 3
♥ J 10 9 5
♦ 8 7 3 2
♣ 7 5 2

♠ A 9 7 6
♥ A Q 4
♦ A J 4
♣ Q 10 8



♠ K J 5 2
♥ 8 6 3
♦ K 10 9
♣ A 6 4

♠ 10 8 4
♥ K 7 2
♦ Q 6 5
♣ K J 9 3

With 9 points SOUTH is unable to decide the final contract. If NORTH has 17 points then the partnership should be playing 3NT. If NORTH opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So SOUTH makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells NORTH that he must make the final call - go on to game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal NORTH has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠ 2			

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 4 2
♥ A 7 3
♦ 10 8 4
♣ 8 7 4

♠ 8 5 3

♥ J 10

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ A J 6 2



♠ A 10 6

♥ K 9 8

♦ A J 2

♣ K 10 9 5

♠ J 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ Q 3

This time EAST has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

WEST has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between 24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

EAST, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1NT

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

Lead: ♥4

Board 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 8
♥ Q
♦ K 10 9 8 6
♣ A Q 10 4

♠ J 7 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 4 2
♣ 9 8 7 3



♠ 10 5 3
♥ K 9 7 6 4 2
♦ 7 5 3
♣ 6

♠ K Q 6
♥ A J 10 3
♦ A Q
♣ K J 5 2

SOUTH has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution. It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 2 points to SOUTH's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

West	North	East	South
			2NT
All Pass			
2NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 10			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 8
♥ A 10 9
♦ K Q 10 8
♣ K 9 7

♠ 6 5 4
♥ K 6 5 4 3
♦ A 7
♣ A 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7 3
♥ Q 7 2
♦ J 9 4
♣ Q J 10 8

♠ Q J 9 2
♥ J 8
♦ 6 5 3 2
♣ 6 4 2

WEST has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

EAST has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking WEST to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But WEST has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice. In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points. Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good" and bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			Pass
1NT	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7 3
♥ 10 9 8 6 2
♦ A 7
♣ 5 4 2

♠ K Q J
♥ A 4
♦ K Q 10 8
♣ A J 7 3



♠ A 5 4
♥ Q J 3
♦ J 6 3 2
♣ 10 9 8

♠ 10 9 6 2
♥ K 7 5
♦ 9 5 4
♣ K Q 6

NORTH has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

SOUTH has 8 points. She adds NORTH's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and NORTH passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q